COM2020 – Project Setup and Ideation

Week 1 Workshop

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Warm up! – 10 mins

In your groups

Each person shares

- One substantial practical problem that could be addressed using computation and or data
- One idea for how software or data might help solve it

Defining the Problem – 20 mins

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Choose one idea from your group and run with it.

Let's break it down:

- Who is the user?
- What is their main frustration?
- Why does this problem matter?

Write your answers on the A3 paper in front of you.

Tips!

When choosing your user, be specific.
Instead of "students" or "teachers", pick one clear group (e.g. first-year students in halls, final-year commuters).

Prioritising features with MoSCoW

For your chosen idea, apply **MoSCoW prioritisation** to decide what matters most.

- **What is MoSCoW?**
  MoSCoW is a simple way to prioritise features by importance.
  It helps you focus on what must be built first and avoid trying to do everything at once.

- **MoSCoW stands for:**
- **Must have** – essential features the project cannot work without
- **Should have** – important features but not critical for the first version
- **Could have** – nice to have features if there is time
- **Will not have** – features that are explicitly out of scope for now

Task: Create a table like the one below on your A3 sheet and fill it in for your project – 20 mins

Must have	Should have	Could have	Will not have

Creating a Project Summary – 15 mins

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Write one short paragraph answering:

- What are we building?
- Who is it for?
- What problem does it solve?
- How will we know it works?

Things to think of!

- How would you measure success?
- What data would you need?
- Why is this doable in 11 weeks?

Let's define the team roles – 10 mins

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Each member in a team have a role and a responsibility assigned.

Roles :

- Project Lead
  Keeps the team organised and tracks progress
- Technical Lead
  Makes technical decisions and keeps code quality high
- Data or ML Lead
  Handles data, modelling, and evaluation if relevant
- Requirements and UX Lead
  Defines what the system should do and keeps the user in focu
- QA and Testing Lead
  Plans testing and checks that features work as expected
- Documentation and Comms Lead
  Maintains documentation and prepares demos and reports

Task!

As a group, decide who will take on each role.

Tip:

Think about each person's skills and where they would be best applied.

Version release thinking – 15 mins

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For your project, define three versions

The elevator pitch: sell, sell, sell

Finally, nominate someone from your team to deliver an elevator pitch. They will have 30 seconds to grab the interest of a potential client (That will be one of the TAs) .

Make sure you articulate 'why' your idea is needed and how it will be delivered successfully.